

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ACTOR REPORT

New China-based Group Expands Operations to Compromise Diplomatic Targets in South America

Date of Publication

February 15, 2023

Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2023081

Summary

First Appearance: February 2023

Actor Name: DEV-0147

Target Region: South America, Asia, and Europe

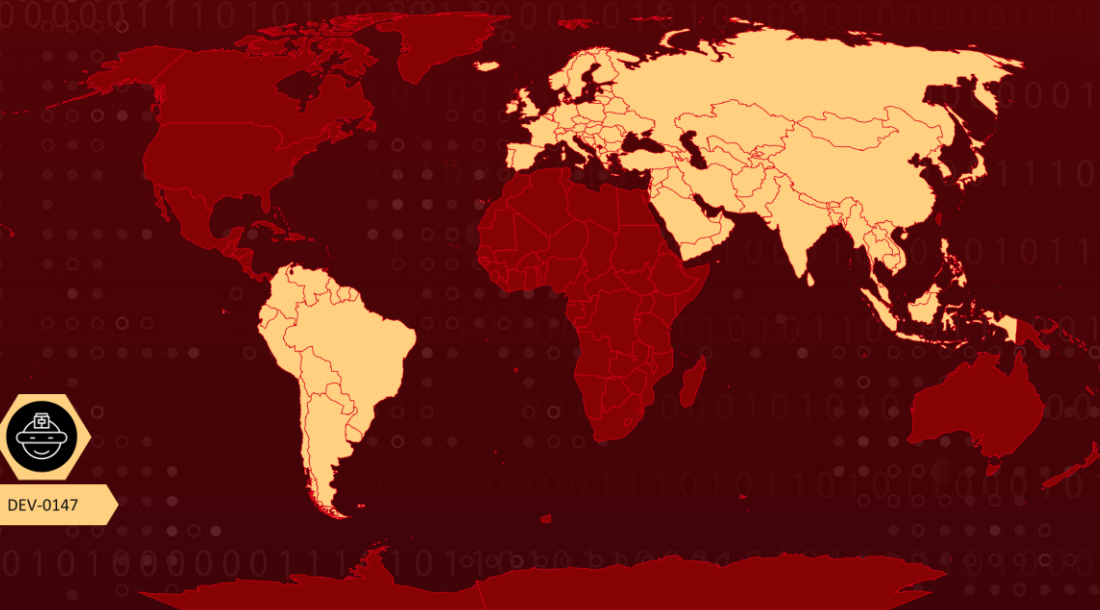
Target Sectors: Diplomatic Entities, Government, and Think Tanks



Actor Map



DEV-0147



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Actor Details

The China-based cyber espionage group DEV-0147 has expanded its data exfiltration operations to include diplomatic targets in South America, in addition to targeting government agencies and think tanks in Asia and Europe. The group uses tools like ShadowPad and QuasarLoader for persistent access and deploying malware and employed post-exploitation activities to abuse identity infrastructure and use Cobalt Strike for command and control and data exfiltration.



Actor Group

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET REGIONS	TARGET INDUSTRIES
DEV-0147	China	South America, Asia and Europe	Diplomatic Entities, government agencies and think tanks
	MOTIVE		
	Data Exfiltration		

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actor through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5’s Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the ‘Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs’ & ‘Indicators of Compromise (IoC)’ on the following pages.

🌐 Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0008</u> Lateral Movement	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>T1584</u> Compromise Infrastructure
<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1505</u> Server Software Component	<u>T1505.003</u> Web Shell	<u>T1219</u> Remote Access Software
<u>T1021</u> Remote Services	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer	<u>T1204</u> User Execution
<u>T1204.002</u> Malicious File			

🌐 References

<https://twitter.com/MsftSecIntel/status/1625181255754039318>

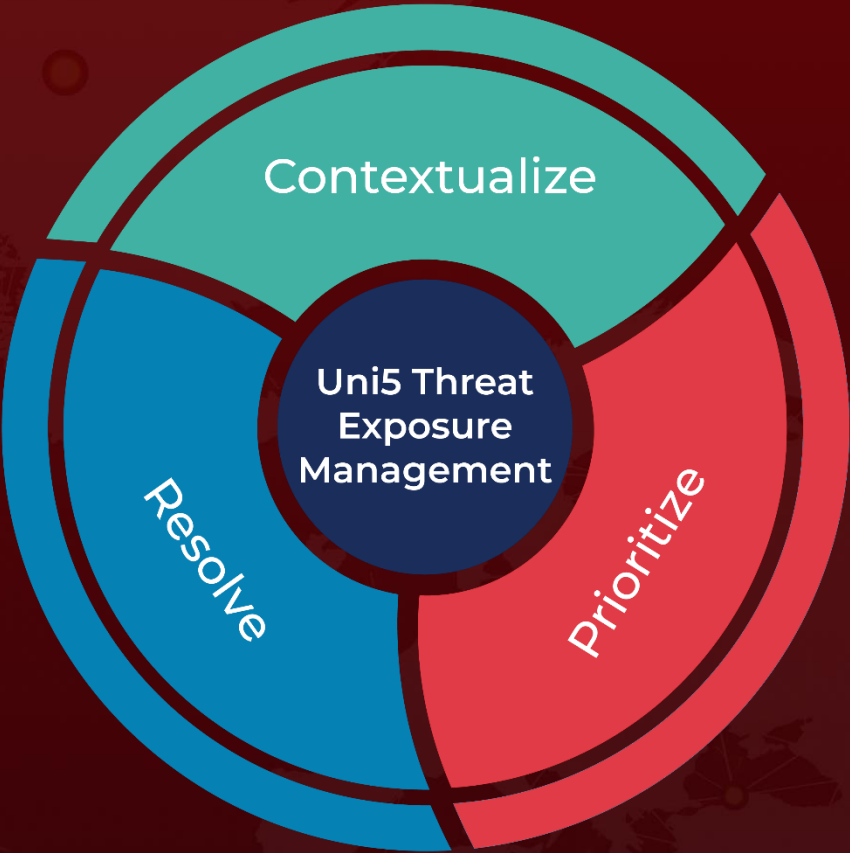
<https://cybernews.com/news/china-cyber-spy-south-america-microsoft/>

<https://thehackernews.com/2023/02/chinese-hackers-targeting-south.html>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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